Colorado which all flows over the plateau of Columbia. These rivers form a barrier to communication but whose water has been dammed for irrigation and power. The River Yukon rising in the north-west of the Western mountain system is frozen for eight months in the year. The River Rio Grande flows into the Gulf of Mexico and forms the boundary between USA and Mexico.

DO YOU KNOW?

Grand Canyon is a steep-sided Canyon carved by the Colorado River in Arizona State of USA

Numerous lakes are found in the glaciated parts of the continent and especially in North Minnesota. These lakes are small and they are used for recreational purposes. The Great Lakes are formed across the continent from west to east. The most important chain consists of five lakes. The biggest is Lake Superior and it is the largest freshwater lake in the world. Lake Winnipeg, Great Bear Lake and Lake Athabasca are some of the other lakes in Canada.



Mississippi River

DO YOU KNOW?

The Mississippi river has been given the nickname "The Big Muddy" because it erodes a lot of sand and mud on its passage.

Some of the States in United States of America are named after the tributaries of these two mighty rivers the Mississippi and Missouri.

Climate

The vast latitudinal extend from the Tropical region to the Polar Regions makes the climate of North America as varied as that of Asia. Unlike the Himalayas, the Rockies run north to south which do not act as a climatic barrier and can not prevent the icy winds from the Arctic region. So the cold winds penetrating the central plains which therefore have a very long cold winter and very short hot summer. Precipitation occurs due to cyclonic storms. The Arctic region is cold and mostly dry and has a very short summer and a very long bitterly cold winter. As one proceeds southwards the short summer becomes warm but the winter is very cold. The central plains had extreme climate. Freezing conditions in winter and tropical heat in summer.

The South is usually warm all the year round and the regions around the mouth of the Mississippi-Missouri and the Gulf Coast have summer rain from the North East Trades which blow on-shore in summer. The warm moist South Westerlies not only bring rainfall to the North West coast and also keep it warm. The warm Alaskan Current keeps the North West coast ice free. The State of California in USA has a Mediterranean Climate with moist winter and dry summers.

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